



One Missing Bell, Three Literary Forms

Grade 4 • Maryland • Reading / drama / poetry

RL.4.5

Compare how prose, drama, and poetry use structural features to tell an event. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 4 • Maryland • Reading / drama / poetry; RL.4.5. Focus: Compare how prose, drama, and poetry use structural features to tell an event.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 3 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

Prose commonly uses sentences and paragraphs; drama gives actors dialogue and stage directions; poetry uses purposeful lines and may group them in stanzas. Not all poems rhyme. Compare the effect of each form, not just its appearance. Read all three original versions below.

Model 1 • How can a script show hesitation without a narrator?

Use a stage direction such as [pauses at the door]. It guides an actor's action.

Model 2 • Does a line break make a sentence ungrammatical?

No. A poem may spread one sentence across several lines to shape emphasis or pace.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



A. Prose: The Bell

Ari reached for the bell that signaled cleanup, but the hook was empty. He searched under the art table. Beside a brush lay a scrap of silver ribbon. Ari followed another scrap to a cardboard castle. Inside it, Bea was fitting the bell into a pretend tower. “May the tower borrow it after cleanup?” she asked. Ari smiled and held out his hand.



B. Drama: The Bell

Cast: Ari, Bea. Setting: an art room.

ARI: [checks the empty hook] Where is our bell?

BEA: [inside a cardboard castle] Listen to my tower!

ARI: We need it for cleanup.

BEA: [offers the bell] May the tower borrow it afterward?

ARI: [smiles] Afterward.



C. Poem: The Bell

An empty hook,
a waiting hand—
a silver trail
across the land.

A cardboard tower
borrows a sound;
we ring for cleanup,
then pass it around.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. Which version uses a cast list?

2. Which uses two stanzas?

3. Which tells most events through a narrator's sentences?

4. Quote one stage direction from B and explain its purpose.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. How many lines are in C's first stanza?

6. Name a rhyming pair in C.

7. What does the blank line in C separate?

8. How does B show who is speaking?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. What detail about Ari’s search appears only in A?

10. Which version explicitly ends with sharing the bell?

11. What would actors do with “[offers the bell]”?

12. How does “a waiting hand” differ from “Ari reached”?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Describe one similarity in the events across all versions.

14. Explain one structural difference between A and B.

15. Turn one sentence from A into a script line and direction.

16. Write two poem lines about the bell; explain a line-break choice.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. Which form gives actors directions? Name two features.

18. Which two features identify C as poetry?

19. Does prose never contain dialogue? Explain using A.

20. Explain how one form changes the reader's experience of the event.



Answers and response criteria

1. B, drama.
2. C, poem.
3. A, prose.
4. Example: “[checks the empty hook]” tells the actor an action that reveals the problem.
5. Four.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. hand/land or sound/around.

7. Two stanzas; it groups the discovery and the resolution.

8. Speaker names before each line of dialogue.

9. He searches under the art table and follows ribbon scraps; accept a specific unique detail.

10. C: “then pass it around.” A and B imply future borrowing, but do not state passing it around.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. Bea would physically offer the bell to Ari.
12. Poem uses a compact image; prose names Ari and tells the action directly.
13. A bell is in a cardboard tower and needed for cleanup.
14. A uses narrated paragraphs; B uses named speakers and actor directions.
15. Example: ARI: [looks beneath table] I found a ribbon. Must separate speech/action coherently.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Accept original lines and a plausible explanation of emphasis/pause. Rhyming is optional.

17. Drama; cast/speaker labels and stage directions.

18. Intentional line breaks and stanzas; rhyme also acceptable.

19. No. A includes Bea's spoken question inside narrated prose.

20. Example: B makes us imagine a performance, while A lets a narrator lead us through the search. Require a structural feature and its effect.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://marylandpublicschools.org/programs/Documents/ELA/revised-standards/Grade-Levels/Grade-4-Reading-Literature-A.pdf>

Research limit: official released-assessment retrieval was unsuccessful in this run. This packet is standards-focused classroom instruction; it makes no released-test alignment, timing, or scoring claim.

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